

Draft RSE Award

Categories, evaluation criteria and indicators

Fabian Lochner

fabian.lochner@gi.de

Gesellschaft für Informatik e.V.

2026-08-24

Abstract

test abstract

Keywords: keyword1; keyword2; keyword3; keyword4

1 Award categories

Category	Sub-Category	Format	Eligibility
Artefact Track	-	Open call	RS must have an artefact badge from a German or DACH conference
Scientific Excellence	Humanities and Social Sciences	Open call	1. RS must be published in a scientific peer-reviewed journal 2. Researchers must be affiliated with a German or DACH university/research institution
	Life Sciences		
	Natural Sciences		
	Engineering		
Newcomer	-	Open call	1. PhD (and master) students from a German or DACH university/research institution 2. Submission of motivation letter

Table 1: Award categories, format and eligibility criteria. RS = Research software

Open questions:

- Keeping Artefact Track as a separate category or not?
 - Could also be a requirement for the “Engineering” sub-category.
 - From all > 100 GI-Fachgruppen only two German/DACH conferences were found with an artefact evaluation track (DELFI 2026, BTW 2025)

2 Process/timeline

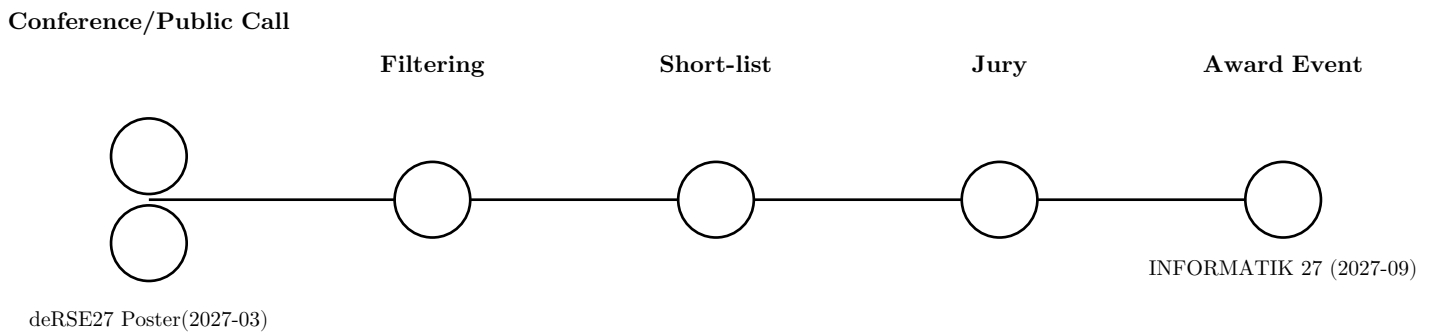


Figure 1: Process timeline of the RSE Award, from public call to award event

2.1 Scientific Excellence category

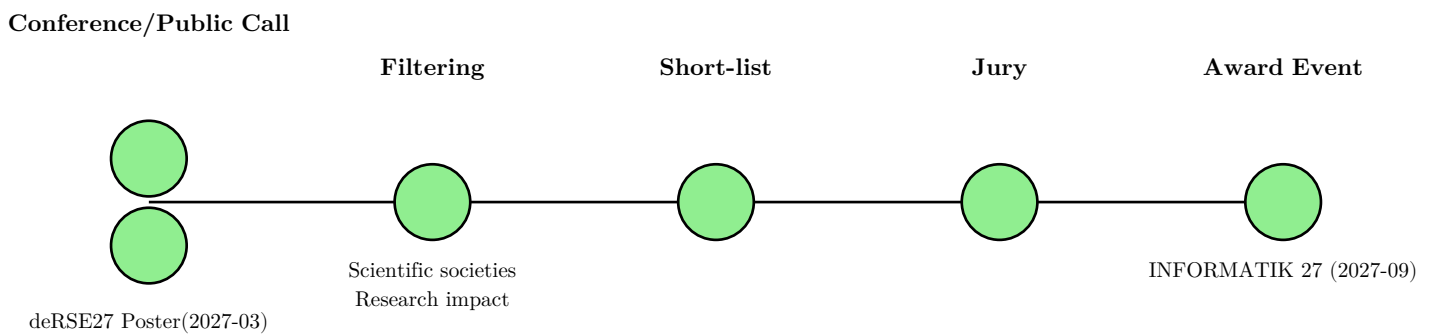


Figure 2: Process timeline for the Scientific Excellence category

Open questions:

- Process with scientific societies unclear

2.2 Newcomer category

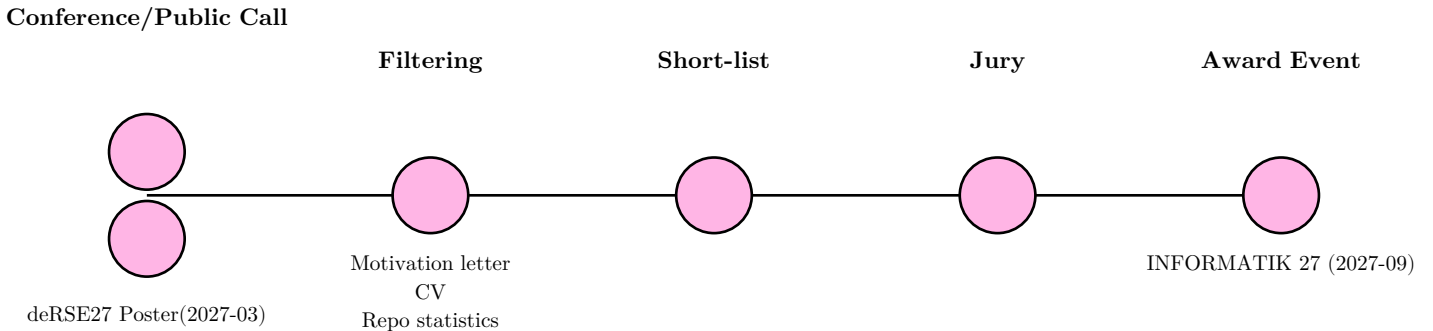


Figure 3: Process timeline for the Newcomer category

3 Filtering

Category	Filter Criteria	Filter Indicators
Artefact Track	-	-
Scientific Excellence	Scientific societies	
	Research impact	Number of citations, Number of paper downloads Ranking of the journal
Newcomer	Motivation letter	Relevance of RS for community
		CV
	Community Engagement, Repo statistics	Stars, Forks, Watch
		Contributor growth, Pull requests
		Issues, Commit frequency

Table 2: Filter system

4 Jury composition & award ceremony

4.1 Jury composition

- “Scientific Excellence” category: Probably 1 jury for each sub-category (4 in total) -> domain knowledge important

- “Newcomer” category: a sample of the jury people from “Scientific Excellence” category
- How many people? Decision rules?
- Using evaluation system provided by us (see below)

List of relevant people for jury:

- [GI RSE Fachgruppe Leitungsgremium](#)
- deRSE conference orga team; see [deRSE26](#)
- [CORSES — Collaborative RSE Services project](#)
- [find.software project](#)
- [Ben Hermann](#), mentioned in a previous AK meeting

4.2 Award ceremony

- idea: INFORMATIK 27 (2027-09)
- invite someone from DFG; see [DFG Förderprogramm “Forschungssoftwareinfrastrukturen”](#)

5 Evaluation criteria and indicators

5.1 Artefact Track and Scientific Excellence

	Software Engineering Level	Research Impact	Community Engagement	FAIRness & (Reproducibility)	Maintainability & Sustainability
Definition	This criterion evaluates the adherence to best practices of coding and software engineering principles.	This criterion evaluates the scientific impact of the research software.	This criterion evaluates the degree of community engagement to the research software.	This criterion evaluates the adherence to the FAIR4RS principles, which are part of the Open Science concept.	This criterion evaluates the long-term stability and maintainability of the research software.
Indicators	<i>Best SE practices (e.g., modularity, readability, efficiency); Software has tests (unit, integration, system tests); Software test coverage (code, branch, threshold, completeness); Human code review requirement (pull requests)</i>	<i>Number of citations; Ranking of the journal; Number of paper downloads</i>	<i>Repo contribution stats (guidelines, contributors, pull requests, commit frequency, issues); Repo popularity stats (stars, watch, forks, downloads); Active communication channels and documentation pages</i>	<i>CodeMeta completeness; descriptive metadata; license; persistent identifier; archived in Software Heritage/scholarly repo; uses citation; versioning standards; containerized</i>	<i>Repo is active; has releases; up-to-date metadata; has dependency management solution; uses issue tracking system; current phase in the Software Development Life Cycle</i>
Sources	Projektantrag, EVERSE indicators , Helmholtz Software Award				

Table 3: Evaluation criteria and indicators for the Artefact Track and Scientific Excellence category

Each criterion is rated on an ordinal scale, from 1 (minimum) to 5 (outstanding).

5.2 Newcomer

	Community Engagement	
Definition		
Indicators		
Sources		

Table 4: Evaluation criteria and indicators for the Newcomer category

Each criterion is rated on an ordinal scale, from 1 (minimum) to 5 (outstanding).

Appendix